

India can cut electricity consumption for lighting by 50 per cent with LEDs

As per United States Department of Energy (USDOE), lighting causes five to six per cent of overall greenhouse gas emissions globally. LEDs can greatly help in mitigating the adverse effects of greenhouse emissions, as these consume 80 to 85 per cent less electricity than conventional lighting sources and have much higher operating lifetimes (more than 50,000 hours). And unlike CFLs, LEDs release zero mercury toxicity into the environment.

As per a report in *Economic Times*, 300 million LED bulbs have been distributed under Ujala Yojana

programme, till May 2018. Imported LEDs (from China, Taiwan and Korea) and the unorganised sector are currently dominating the market. This is due to an absence of national-level standardisation and regulations for the domestic supply chain framework.

Indian industry lacks the manufacturing ecosystem and the research needed for upcoming technologies in the LED sector. In India, lighting constitutes 18 per cent of total electricity usage. Savings in electricity are expected to be close to 50 per cent if LEDs are used in tandem with smart metering, smart designing and connected light-

ing, across the country. Lighting will then consume only nine to 11 per cent of the total electricity used in India.

Hence, it is imperative for the government to constitute a policy framework that enables standardisation and regulatory mechanisms in the lighting industry. To support domestic manufacturing, the government can assist by facilitating financial incentives (such as offering subsidies on capital, on production output, etc). Indian academic institutes and research laboratories can also collaborate on R&D on promising LED technologies.

On The Move

Anshu Prakash joins as additional secretary for DoT

In a major move to push forward some of the ongoing initiatives in the telecom department, the government of India has appointed Anshu Prakash as additional secretary in Department of Telecommunications (DoT), under Ministry of Communications. The government has shifted the current special secretary N. Sivasailam to Department of Commerce as special secretary for logistics.

Knowlarity appoints telecom veteran Yatish Mehrotra as CEO

Knowlarity, a cloud communications platform provider, has announced the appointment of veteran telecom professional Yatish Mehrotra as chief executive officer (CEO). In this role, Mehrotra will spearhead the company's overall business and growth strategy. He has over 25 years of experience with telecom operators, holding leadership positions in companies like Tata Teleservices and Airtel.

Sushant Kashyap joins MobiKwik as business head

Digital payment company MobiKwik has

appointed Sushant Kashyap as business head for its payment gateway and international business. Prior to joining MobiKwik, Kashyap spent more than 15 years working with Delhivery and Airtel, and managed strategic business relationships across e-commerce and telecom sectors.

Automation Anywhere appoints Milan Sheth as EVP

Robotic process automation (RPA) company Automation Anywhere has appointed Milan Sheth as executive vice president (EVP) for India, Middle East and Africa (IMEA) region. In his new role, Sheth will help companies expedite their digital transformation journey by realising the combined power of RPA and artificial intelligence (AI) to automate mundane business processes.

Niladri Datta joins IFB Appliances as chief of marketing and strategy

Niladri Datta, LG Electronics India's ex-marketing head, has joined IFB Appliances as its chief of marketing and strategy. He has more than 24 years of experience in the industry. He worked with LG electronics for about 14 years from 2004 to 2018 in various capacities,

including head of washing machine business, modern trade head, head of managing director's task team and chief marketing officer. He was responsible for making LG's washing machine business a market leader.

Abhijit Bose appointed head of WhatsApp India

Abhijit Bose, who was co-founder and chief executive officer of electronic payment firm Ezetap, has been appointed as head of WhatsApp India. Bose will build WhatsApp's first full-country team outside of California, USA and will be based in Gurugram. He will focus on helping businesses, both large and small, connect with their customers.

WhatsApp chief business officer Neeraj Arora quits

Neeraj Arora, WhatsApp's chief business officer, has quit the company after seven years. His exit comes seven months after WhatsApp co-founder Jan Koum left the company. Arora was an integral part of WhatsApp since 2011, and played a critical role in the company's acquisition by Facebook in 2014.